

Literature

General Lit
Lit./Mythology





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8, General Lit: Grades 7-8

About General Lit: Grades 7-8

Students spend extended time with a 19th century novel and personal narrative and will find rich opportunities for discussion and inspiration.

About Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8

Student get a glimpse of the world beyond English with a poetic biography and then focus on stories and myths created and collected in the 19th century, including Russian fairy tales, short stories from a variety of authors, and Dickens' famous text, A Christmas Carol.



Placement & Combining Tips

Literature: Grades 7-8

Poetry lessons are also an integral part of the whole Literature program, so look at both literature and poetry selections together when placing students.

General Lit: Grades 7-8

Suitable for Grades 9-10. Due to more challenging content, we do not advise using these lessons with younger students if combining.

Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8

Several readings are shared with Grades 5-6, though lesson plans include more advanced work for older students.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-8	General Lit: Grades 7-8 1 time/week 30 min	Little Women Sir Gibbie Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass
7-8	Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 1 time/week 30 min	The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist A Christmas Carol The Man Who Invented Christmas directed Short stories and other writings

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grades 7-8				
General Lit: Grades 7-8				Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

General Lit: Grades 7-8

Term 3 sensitive content: The Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass contains several graphic descriptions of beatings, killing, and racial slurs. While the directness of his account was essential for communicating the horrors of slavery, parents or teachers should decide the best way to discuss the violence on the following pages with their students: 3-5, 7, 13-15, 21, 33 40-41.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Literature: Grades 7-8

General Lit: Grades 7-8



Little Women



Sir Gibbie



Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8



The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist



A Christmas Carol



The Man Who Invented Christmas directed

Short stories and other writings



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Literature: Grades 7-8

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Literature: Grades 7-8

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance, especially for Shakespeare lessons. It is helpful to read the play or a preview of it beforehand.
- Choose which books to have students read independently. See Planning and Prep notes for recommendations.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember and/or predict what might come next. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If students have difficulty recalling, try showing an illustration, sharing something that you remember, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading and/or using a combination of visual and audio support this time) or repeating the last lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage aloud or have students read independently. For Shakespeare, it is highly recommended that each student have their own copy of the play and that you read it aloud together or read along and underline/make notes while listening to the audio recording.
- Use supportive strategies and educational tools to reduce frustration and better engage the mind, as appropriate. These could include, but are not limited to, the use of eBooks, pictures, audio, read-aloud, buddy reading, colored reading strips, etc.
- Some students may benefit from having a notebook or piece of scrap paper available to externalize ideas by drawing, recording names, or making symbolic 'squiggle' notes.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Keep an eye out for things to add to your Book of Centuries, Citizenship Notebook, and Copywork book.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or in writing. If writing, encourage students to use the full remaining lesson time and include as much detail as they can remember. For Shakespeare or

challenging books, it may be helpful to narrate more frequently and/or use props.

- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Students who used paper or a notebook to externalize may refer to these for support. Other students who need external support may benefit from looking at a map or picture from the book while narrating.
- Students who tend to use the same type of narration all the time can be encouraged to try another form of narration by first doing it together through play or discussion.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill that requires the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today; notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they tell you about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note or take a break for the day, if necessary.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you can ask an open-ended question or use an included discussion question.



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 1

Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

PREP (Option 1: Little Women): Read the bio and share parts with your students in the lesson.

∞ Article Link: Louisa May Alcott Bio

→ INTRO

Little Women was published in 2 volumes. We will read Volume 1, published originally in 1868. Little Women was the first American novel written for girls, though it had wide appeal upon publication, with boys, adult women, and men as well. It was a move away from overly preachy children's literature and was an immediate success, changing how novels for young people were written.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1 "Playing Pilgrims"

- If you read Pilgrim's Progress in younger grades, keep an eye out for many different references or allusions to the book as you read Little Women. Did you notice any in this chapter? (Hint: the name of the chapter is one reference!)

→ INTRO (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)

George MacDonald was an author, poet, minister, and dreamer born on the rugged moors of northern Scotland in 1824. His early years were marked by loss, as his mother died when he was just eight years old. MacDonald entered Aberdeen University at sixteen, where he studied Chemistry and Physics, and then attended Highbury Theological College in London and entered the ministry. After being pushed out of his church for preaching that God was more loving and forgiving than most people dared to believe during that time, he turned to writing and became one of the biggest literary celebrities of his era. Part of his motivation for writing was to support his large family of 11 children! His wife, Louisa Powell MacDonald, served as his editor, critic, and business manager, and kept the large family afloat during severe financial struggles. He wrote over 50 books, including some children's books you may have read, such as *At the Back of the North Wind*, *The Princess and the Goblin*, and *The Princess and Curdie*. (If you haven't read them, they are great books for any age!) Despite the influence of MacDonald during his lifetime, much of his work was nearly lost to time after his death, including *Sir Gibbie*. MacDonald used his native Scots language extensively in several of his novels, like this one, which created a stumbling block for readers. Thankfully, several of his books have been rediscovered and republished with Scots and English translations for modern readers. Regarded as the "grandfather of fantasy literature," he inspired great writers like C.S. Lewis, J.R.R. Tolkien, and G.K. Chesterton.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

When starting a new book, it is helpful to look over the book's contents first. In addition to getting a feel for what the book will be about, you will often save yourself considerable time discovering tools and tips the author has already left for you! You'll notice on the title page that we are told there will be "Side-by-Side English/Scots Dialogue." By flipping through the book, you can see on page 2 what that will look like - the original Scots text on the left, the translated English text on the right. (The acknowledgements tell us more about this.) We are also given a list of MacDonald's other Scottish novels, so we can infer something about the author's nationality even if we haven't read one of his books before. You'll also notice a list of quotes about MacDonald from some very famous

★ TEACHER NOTE (Little Women)

See Extra Helpings for suggested audio versions, as this can be a fun book to listen to in the afternoons or at other times to create flexibility in your schedule.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Little Women published (1868AD)
Sir Gibbie Published (1879AD)

★ TEACHER NOTE (Sir Gibbie)

∞ Article Link: George MacDonald biography



Term 1

authors who were fans of his work! You may want to bookmark the cast of characters just before the start of chapter one to refer back to. If you flip to the back of the book, you'll find an appendix with literal translations of all the Scots poems that appear in the book. During this first week of lessons, take some time to look over the other new books you encounter before you start reading. It's a very helpful habit to develop!

- Read the "Cast of Characters" and then p. 1-7. Sometimes when starting a new book, it is helpful to read the first chapter aloud so you can get familiar with the rhythm and cadence of the writing. It will take a little bit to feel comfortable with MacDonald's descriptions, word choices, and sentence structure. Having someone else read the first couple of chapters to you may be another way to feel a bit more at home in the story.

- This story lends itself to many interesting ways of narrating. Drawing or painting a scene from each chapter is one way that would work well, as MacDonald's descriptive writing creates such vivid images in our minds. Can you picture Gibbie searching in the gutter looking for the earring? Or how about peering over the half door, looking longingly at the bread and penny rolls? Or maybe his joy at giving the now-found lost earring back to its owner? Another option for narrating would be to find another student or a friend of any age to tell the story to, chapter by chapter, as you read it each week. Read your chapters for school and then, sometime during the week, tell the story to someone else. Keep it up week after week until they know the story through your narrations! Discuss your thoughts with your teacher about how you would like to narrate.

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: George MacDonald: The Man Behind Middle Earth and Narnia

WEEK 1 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 1

Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda

📄 Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ INTRO

Today we will begin a novel in verse about the Cuban-Spanish Romantic poet Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda (1814-1873), who used her writing to speak out against injustice of all kinds. If you have not read her biography already, it is linked below.

∞ Article Link: Biography of Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

1. p.169-174 "Historical Note"
2. p.ix "Historical Background"
3. p.3-10 "Books are door-shaped" - "like oxen or mules."

- Who are the people? Make a character list. Each week, as you read, think about the different perspectives of the poems and how each one sees the same situation very differently. Share your observations in your narrations.

- How do the alternating viewpoints allow the poems to speak to each other? Look for poems that discuss the same topic but from different perspectives.

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Link: What Are Free Verse Poems

WEEK 2 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 2

📄 Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)

Who are the "Little Women" and what is the setting for the book?

• EXTRA HELPING (Little Women)

∞ Article Link: Christmas During the Civil War



Term 1

→ INTRO

Name as many things as you can that are happening in the world during the late 1800s when *Little Women* was written and published.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2 "A Merry Christmas"

- How do the March sisters show joy despite their circumstances?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)

Recall what was happening in the story from last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.8-29 (Chapters 2-4)

→ NOTE (ABOUT READING SPEED)

You may find, at the beginning of the book especially, that it is taking you longer to read the assigned pages than you have minutes in the lesson. You have a few options if that is your situation. One would be to ignore the page numbers assigned and read what you can in 20 minutes each week, so you have time to paint or tell someone the story in the remaining 10 minutes of the lesson. Or if you want to schedule your painting or telling the story for another time later in the day, you could read for the full 30 minutes in the lesson. Another option is to read what you can in the lesson and then finish the assigned reading for the week in the evening or on the weekend. It all depends on whether you want to finish the book in the two terms it is assigned in or if you don't mind finishing it outside of lesson time if need be. You will probably find that you will be able to read a bit faster as you get further into the story, once the language becomes more familiar. Discuss your plan with your teacher if you find yourself pressed for time in the lesson. There is no point in rushing through the story and missing the enjoyment of reading it! Another option is to add 10 more minutes to this lesson so you can read comfortably if needed.

→ NOTE (ABOUT DISCUSSION OF THE STORY)

Depending on your setting and schedule, your teacher might want to add an additional 10 minutes to this lesson for discussion. Or you may decide to schedule a longer time once per week to discuss several of your readings from the week. Others may choose to discuss certain books at a meal with family members or friends. The point is to enjoy the books and to enjoy thinking and talking about them. Sometimes a Discussion Question will be provided, but there is plenty in every chapter to discuss, so feel free to change the question.

- Gibbie never speaks- yet from the first chapter, he is unmistakably present. How does MacDonald do that?

WEEK 2 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 2

Lightning Dreamer, cont.

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What were your first impressions of these poems?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

p.11-24 "I feel like a new person" - "dark or light."

- How are the nuns able to support Tula?
- How did Tula's father influence her, and how has his death shaped who she is at thirteen?

• COMPOSITION

What role do books and reading have in the story so far? How are the "rules" different for Tula? Caridad? The nuns?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Link: José María Heredia biography

Literature: Grades 7-8

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Term 1

- Why does Tula feel she is not so different from the slave girls she views from the barred window?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 3 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 3

Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)

What was Christmas like in the March home?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3 "The Laurence Boy"

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)

Recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.30-53 (Chapters 5-7)

- Try reading a passage aloud in Scots, then English. What is lost or gained?

• EXTRA HELPING (Little Women)

∞ Article Link: Civil War Dresses

WEEK 3 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 3

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

How would you describe this book (so far) to someone who had never read it?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.25-35

- How do the decisions Tula's mother made differ from what she expects from Tula? What is your impression of her mother so far?
- Why does Tula feel she can free herself "only with words"?
- Why is Tula not allowed to read books? What are her mother and stepfather afraid of happening if she reads books?

WEEK 4 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 4

Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)

Who did the March sisters meet in the last chapter? What is he like?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4 "Burdens"

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Link: The Alcotts' Home, which was the inspiration for the Marchs' home.

- Describe some of the burdens the sisters feel they carry. Which seems hardest to you?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)

Recall what you read last time.

Literature: Grades 7-8

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Term 1

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
p.54-79 (Chapters 8-10)

WEEK 4 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 4

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ **RECAP**

What did we learn about Tula's situation in the last chapter? What does her future hold?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
p.39-55

- What have we learned about Caridad and why she might not want to share stories of her childhood?
- What need does the orphan theater fill for Tula? Why does she have to change the stories her plays tell?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 5

Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ **RECAP (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)**

What are some of the chores or work the sisters are responsible for?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.5 "Being Neighborly"

→ **VIEW (OPTIONAL)**

∞ Video Link: Transcendentalism and the Alcotts

→ **RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)**

Recall what you read last time.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
p.80-108 (Chapters 11-14)

- Glashgar Mountain is described almost as a living presence. How does MacDonald use landscape as a character?

• **EXTRA HELPINGS (Little Women)**

Read this memorial poem about Thoreau by Alcott.

∞ **Link:** Thoreau's Flute

Read about the link between Alcott and Ralph Waldo Emerson in the article linked below.

∞ **Article Link:** Alcott and Emerson

WEEK 5 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 5

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ **RECAP**

What do you remember about the orphan theater?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
p.56-70

- What was Manuel's concern in this chapter? Is it for Tula? Or himself?
- How does reading about injustice differ from actually experiencing it for Tula?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 6

Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ **RECAP (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)**

How did Jo show kindness to a neighbor?

• **EXTRA HELPING (Little Women)**

∞ **Video Link:** Pickled Limes

Literature: Grades 7-8

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Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6-7 "Beth Finds the Palace Beautiful" and "Amy's Valley of Humiliation"

- Optional: Have you been noticing the allusions to Pilgrim's Progress? What kind of journey is each of the sisters on, and how is that similar (or dissimilar) to the Pilgrim's journey?
-

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)

Recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.109-126 (Chapters 15-18)

- Donal is a shepherd's son who reads Latin and writes poetry while watching cattle. What does MacDonald seem to believe about the relationship between humble work and intellectual life?
- Have you ever done something good for someone without telling anyone, or have you been tempted to make sure someone noticed? What is the difference in how those feel?

WEEK 6 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 6

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What injustice does Tula experience in the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.73-90

- Has your impression of Tula's mother changed at all throughout the story?
- Do Manuel's actions change your perception of him? How has he supported Tula throughout the story?

• COMPOSITION

Compare the concerns of Tula, Manuel, Caridad, Mama, and the Nuns in pages 73-83. Are they justified or not given the time and setting?

★ TEACHER NOTE

The tertulias brought people together in quiet defiance. They were often political rebellion disguised as parties; a way of sharing counterculture ideas in places where fascist regimes had made it dangerous, even illegal, to gather.

WEEK 7 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 7

Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)

What lesson did Amy learn in the last chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8 "Jo Meets Apollyon"

- What are some of the lessons about anger and temper in this chapter? Do you agree?
-

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)

Recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.127-149 (Chapters 19-21)

- Angus's speech is rough and harsh. Compare it to Janet's - same region, very different character. How does MacDonald use dialect to reveal character?

• COMPOSITION (Little Women)

Pick a scene from the story thus far to turn into a short play.

Literature: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 7 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 7

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What risks were Tula and Manuel taking in the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.90-109

- How does Tula learn to hide her messages?
- What are some of the acts of defiance and courage in the book so far, and what are their consequences?
- Why does Mama imagine their lives will be peaceful and prosperous once Tula is married? Do you think she's right?

WEEK 8 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 8

Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)

What lesson did Jo learn in the last chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9 "Meg Goes to Vanity Fair"

- What temptations does Meg face, and how does she recover?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)

Recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.150-172 (Chapters 22-23)

- What difference does it make to be taught by someone who loves you?

WEEK 8 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 8

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.113-127

- Why can't Tula write even though she now has a degree of freedom with her uncle gone?
- Why does Tula leave the plantation even though she's now left alone there?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 9

Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)

What lesson did Meg learn in the last chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.10 "The P.C. and P.O."

- If you wrote something for the Pickwick Portfolio, what would you write?

• **COMPOSITION (Little Women)**
Write up your idea that you discussed in the lesson! Compose an advertisement, article, or poem for the Pickwick Portfolio. You can retell a scene from Little Women or choose something from another book or even your personal experience to write about. One idea: write a newspaper entry about the

Literature: Grades 7-8

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Term 1

----- → RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE) Recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.173-190 (Chapters 24-25) • What does it cost to be misunderstood- and does it matter?		admission of "Sam Weller" into the club.
WEEK 9 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 9 Materials: Lightning Dreamer → RECAP What was plantation life like for Tula with her uncle gone? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.128-144 • What happens when some of Tula's fantasies about love meet reality? • What things do Sab and Tula have in common despite their differences? What insights does Sab's godmother give them?		• COMPOSITION Explore how Sab and Tula are reflections of each other's freedom dreams. How are their dreams alike? Different?
WEEK 10 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 10 Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie → RECAP (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN) Describe the Pickwick Club. Would you want to join? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.11 "Experiments" • Why do the experiments fail, and what lessons do the girls learn? ----- → RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE) Recall what you read last time. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.191-214 (Chapters 26-27) • The community has built an elaborate mythology about the "beast-boy" of the mountain. What does this say about how communities handle what they don't understand? How do communities see and fail to see?		
WEEK 10 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 10 Materials: Lightning Dreamer → RECAP What do you remember of Sab's story? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.145-159 • Why do you think Tula finally reads her verses in public? • What do you think will happen after Manuel tells Tula what Mama has planned?		

Literature: Grades 7-8

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Term 1

WEEK 11 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 11

Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)

What was the "experiment" in the last chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.12 "Camp Laurence"

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)

Recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.215-244 (Chapters 28-30)

- Donal composes in both Scots and English. What can Scots say that English cannot?

★ TEACHER NOTE (Little Women)

This is a longer chapter and can be finished in the afternoon or next week during exam week.

WEEK 11 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 11

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What happened when Tula went to the city to live?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.160-167 & p.175-179

- We are told why Tula is fleeing to Spain. Why do you think Manuel is joining her? Does this contradict Tula's thoughts that men are freer than women?
- What has Tula learned about love during the book?

WEEK 12 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Little Women OR Sir Gibbie

★ TEACHER NOTE (Little Women)

Finish chapter from last week as needed.

WEEK 12 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 12

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Lightning Dreamer

Literature: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 13

Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ INTRO (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)

What does your "dream future" look like 5 or 10 years from now?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.13 "Castles in the Air"

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)

Recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.245-267 (Chapters 31- to part way through 33)

- What can a crisis reveal about a person's faith?

• COMPOSITION (Little Women)

Write a profile or character sketch of one of the sisters. What are they like? Write as if you were telling a friend about them.

WEEK 1 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 13

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ INTRO

A Christmas Carol is a novella, which is longer than a short story but shorter than a novel. It was published on December 19, and the first edition sold out by Christmas Eve, making it an immediate success. Like much of Dickens' writing, the story is a commentary on the social problems of his era, such as poverty, child welfare, and poor working conditions.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-11 Beginning to "closed it with a bang"

- Why do you think Scrooge dislikes Christmas so much?

★ TEACHER NOTE

See extra helpings for suggested audio versions, as this can be a fun book to listen to. Feel free to move reading this book closer to Christmas.

• IMPORTANT DATES

1843 AD: A Christmas Carol published

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ **Video Link:** Life In A Victorian Workhouse

WEEK 2 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 14

Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)

What were some of the sisters' dreams in the previous chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.232-253 "Jo was very busy"- "call her mother."

- How does Alcott use the contrasting personalities of the sisters as foils? A foil is when an author contrasts two characters to emphasize some of their qualities. The word foil refers to backing gems with foil to make them shine brighter.

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

With the remaining time or in the afternoon, learn more about the telegraph.

∞ **Video Link:** The Telegraph: The Civil War Text Machine

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)

Recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.267-288 (partway through chapter 33 to the end of chapter 34)

• IMPORTANT DATES (Little Women)

1830s: Telegraph invented

• EXTRA HELPING (Little Women)

∞ **Article Link:** LMA, Civil War Nurse

Literature: Grades 7-8

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Term 2

WEEK 2 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 14

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

How would you describe Scrooge so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.11-21 "The sound resounded" - "upon the instant." (end of stave one)

- Why does Scrooge try so hard to explain away Marley's ghost?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ **Article Link:** How A Christmas Carol Became A Holiday Classic

WEEK 3 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 15

Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ INTRO (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)

What does good comfort look and feel like? What are ways you've been comforted when sad, or ways that people have tried to comfort you unhelpfully?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.253-274 "Everything was arranged" - end of Ch.16

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)

Recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.289-307 (Chapters 35-36)

- Does being seen change what we did?
- How do different characters respond to learning who Gibbie really is? What do their responses reveal about them?

• COMPOSITION (Little Women)

Write a letter to Jo comforting her during Beth's illness.

★ TEACHER NOTE (Little Women)

Beth likely had Scarlet Fever. Share from or view this short video as desired.

∞ **Video Link:** Scarlet Fever

WEEK 3 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 15

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.22-32 Beginning of Stave two - "upon a winter's night."

- What was Christmas like when Scrooge was young?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ **Article Link:** 10 Things To Know about Charles Dickens' Christmas Carol

WEEK 4 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 16

Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.17-18 "Little Faithful" & "Dark Days"

- Make a character chart of Amy's virtues versus her vanities.

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)

Recall what you read last time.

Literature: Grades 7-8

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Term 2

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
p.308-326 (Chapters 37-39)

- Have you ever had to move between very different worlds- social, cultural, or otherwise? What did you bring with you? What did you have to leave behind?

WEEK 4 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 16

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What mood was Scrooge in when we left off? Notice how his mood changes through stave two.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.32-39 "In came a fiddler" - end of Stave two

- Why were the scenes with Belle so painful for Scrooge?

• COMPOSITION

Compare Scrooge and Fezziwig as employers. What do the actions of each show about leadership and responsibility for your employees?

∞ **Video Link:** Why Read Charles Dickens?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 17

Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)

How did the sisters show care for others in the previous chapters?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.19-20 "Amy's Will" & "Confidential"

- In what ways did Alcott use the literary device of foreshadowing leading up to Beth's illness? Foreshadowing is when an author gives us hints or clues about what might happen later in the story.
 - In what ways does Little Women show that life can be good even through trials and tragedies?
-

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)

Recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.327-352 (Chapters 40-42)

- Donal in the drawing room is one of the novel's comic scenes. Why is it funny, and what makes the comedy also a little painful?

• **COMPOSITION (Little Women)**
Tell about Amy's will from Laurie's point of view, being sure to include what he might have been thinking.

• **EXTRA HELPING (Little Women)**

∞ **Article Link:** Autobiographical Roots of Little Women

WEEK 5 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 17

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What did the Ghost of Christmas Past show Scrooge?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.40-51 Stave three - "blushed to hint at such a thing."

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ **Video Link:** Charles Dickens' Home Tour

WEEK 6 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 18

Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)

Describe what you've learned about Amy.

• **COMPOSITION (Little Women)**
In Ch.21, Jo says, "Hold your tongue!... I came here to moralize, not to hear about things that make me skip to think of." Explain why you think she said this.



Term 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.21 "Laurie Makes Mischief, and Jo Makes Peace"

- Were you satisfied with the resolution of the prank in this chapter? Why or why not? If not, how might you have resolved it differently?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)

Recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.353-379 (Chapters 43-45)

- Mistress Croale reappears here. How has she changed? How has she stayed the same?

WEEK 6 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 18

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What did Scrooge learn by visiting the Cratchit family?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.51-64 "At last the dinner" - end of Stave three

- What do you think the children Ignorance and Want represent?

• COMPOSITION

The Ghost of Christmas Present shows Scrooge two suffering children named Ignorance and Want. What do these children represent, and why do you think Dickens showed them in such a shocking way?

∞ Video Link: Dickens' London

WEEK 7 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 19

Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)

Describe how Jo has changed through the story thus far.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.22 "Pleasant Meadows"

- Choose one sister. How have her personal burdens grown lighter during the story?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)

Recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.380-409 (Chapters 46-48)

- How does Ginevra see Gibbie clearly when others do not? What gives her this capacity?

• ILLUSTRATE (Little Women)

Draw or paint an illustration of Mr. March's return.

WEEK 7 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 19

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

Which ghosts have visited Scrooge so far? Who do you think will visit next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.65-76 Stave four - "there is your father at the door."

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: The Story of A Christmas Carol and Victorian England

Literature: Grades 7-8

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Term 2

WEEK 8 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 20

Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)

What changes did Mr. March notice in the girls?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.23 "Aunt March Settles the Question"

- Why do you think Jo feels sorrow and loss at the end of this chapter despite the celebration going on around her?
 - Choose a sister and discuss how she has changed over the course of the story thus far.
-

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)

Recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.410-433 (Chapters 49-51)

- If you received a large, unexpected inheritance tomorrow, what would you want to do with it?

- **COMPOSITION (Little Women)**
Continue the discussion from the lesson on how you think the sisters have changed over the story. Pick one sister and write about who she was at the beginning of the book, a few ways she has changed, and what you think caused that change.

WEEK 8 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 20

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.76-89 "She hurried out" - end of stave five.

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: How A Christmas Carol Perfectly Demonstrates 5-Act Structure (Note that this is the same structure as many of Shakespeare's plays.)

★ TEACHER NOTE

We will spend the next 3-4 lessons watching the movie "The Man Who Invented Christmas." Please preview for your students as needed.

WEEK 9 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 21

Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ STUDENT'S CHOICE (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)

- Catch up on lessons in this course or another.
 - Explore extra helpings.
 - Pick a discussion question from a previous lesson and write an extended reflection.
 - Start Part 2 of Little Women.
-

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)

Recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.434-457 (Chapters 52-53)

WEEK 9 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 21

→ INTRO

The next few weeks are open for you to watch The Man Who Invented Christmas about the life of Charles Dickens. If you have already seen the movie or decide not to watch it, then use this time to catch up on your

Literature: Grades 7-8

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Term 2

other subjects or read another classic from this time period such as Alice in Wonderland or pick a short story by Sir Arthur Conan Doyle such as The Speckled Band or The Redheaded League.

∞ Link: Alice in Wonderland

∞ Link: The Speckled Band

∞ Link: The Redheaded League

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: The Man Who Invented Christmas (Watch over the next 3-4 lessons.)

WEEK 10 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 22

📖 Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ STUDENT'S CHOICE (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)

- Catch up on lessons in this course or another.
 - Explore extra helpings.
 - Pick a discussion question from a previous lesson and write an extended reflection.
 - Start Part 2 of Little Women.
-

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)

Recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.458-480 (Chapters 54-57)

WEEK 10 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 22

→ INTRO

Today is open for you to watch The Man Who Invented Christmas about the life of Charles Dickens. If you have already seen the movie or decide not to watch it, then use this time to catch up on your other subjects or read another classic from this time period such as Alice in Wonderland or pick a short story by Sir Arthur Conan Doyle such as The Speckled Band or The Redheaded League.

∞ Link: Alice in Wonderland

∞ Link: The Speckled Band

∞ Link: The Redheaded League

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: The Man Who Invented Christmas

WEEK 11 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 23

📖 Materials: Little Women or Sir Gibbie

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS (OPTION 1: LITTLE WOMEN)

∞ Article Link: The Enduring Appeal of Little Women

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: SIR GIBBIE)

Recall what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.481-513 (Chapters 58-62 end of book)

- What does it cost to tell the truth, and what does it cost not to?
- What will you carry with you from this book?

• COMPOSITION (Little Women)

Write a paragraph or two explaining your thoughts on whether Little Women is a "Christian" book. Give examples from the book that support your points.



Term 2

WEEK 11 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 23

→ INTRO

Today is open for you to watch The Man Who Invented Christmas about the life of Charles Dickens. If you have already seen the movie or decide not to watch it, then use this time to catch up on your other subjects or read another classic from this time period such as Alice in Wonderland or pick a short story by Sir Arthur Conan Doyle such as The Speckled Band or The Redheaded League.

∞ Link: Alice in Wonderland

∞ Link: The Speckled Band

∞ Link: The Redheaded League

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: The Man Who Invented Christmas

WEEK 12 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

Little Women OR Sir Gibbie

WEEK 12 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from: A Christmas Carol

Literature: Grades 7-8

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Term 3

WEEK 1 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 25

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

→ INTRO

The Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass is a classic 19th-century autobiography that details the author's story from slavery to freedom. Douglass was born enslaved in Maryland in 1818 and escaped to freedom when he was around twenty years old. He went on to have a remarkable life as a national leader of the abolitionist movement, writer, orator, and statesman.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-7 "I was born in Tuckahoe" - "a good overseer."

- What do we learn about Frederick Douglass's family in this opening reading? What initial impressions do you have of his writing style? How might this be connected to his aims for this autobiography? Consider in particular how he describes the more difficult and violent episodes from his childhood.

• COMPOSITION - Interview

Write an interview with Frederick Douglass on what he remembers from his early childhood.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Sensitive content: See the note in Term Prep & Teacher Tips.

WEEK 1 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 25

"The Celebrated Jumping Frog of Calaveras County" by Mark Twain

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

We've included audio versions of these stories as an alternative to reading the written stories. Short stories can be especially fun to hear aloud with a talented narrator, though it will take longer than reading the story.

Mark Twain (1835–1910) is the pen name of Samuel Clemens, one of America's most celebrated writers, who was known for his sharp wit. His most famous works include "The Adventures of Tom Sawyer" and "Adventures of Huckleberry Finn." Published in 1865, "The Celebrated Jumping Frog" was the story that made Twain a household name. The story blends exaggeration and comic timing in a way that was fresh and distinctly American when it was published. As you read, pay attention not just to what happens, but to how the story is told.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.2-5 "The Celebrated Jumping Frog of Calaveras County" by Mark Twain

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- What makes Simon Wheeler's way of telling his story just as funny as the story itself? Can you think of another story, movie, or TV show where the delivery matters as much as the punchline?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: Mark Twain bio

★ TEACHER NOTE

The second week of this course, we'll read "The Gift of the Magi" by O Henry, which is a Christmas story. Feel free to reschedule this story for closer to Christmas if desired.

WEEK 2 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 26

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.7-13 "The home plantation" - "stone-like coolness."

Literature: Grades 7-8

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Term 3

- Reflect on Douglass's descriptions of the slaves' songs. What purposes does singing serve? How has it been misunderstood?

WEEK 2 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 26

"The Gift of the Magi" by O Henry

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

O. Henry was the pen name of William Sydney Porter (1862–1910), an American writer famous for his short stories about ordinary people — especially the working poor of New York City. His warm, ironic style made him one of the most popular writers of his era. Published in 1905, "The Gift of the Magi" is perhaps his most beloved story. If you have extra time, his biography (see video link) is especially interesting.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.6-9 "The Gift of the Magi" by O Henry

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Were Jim and Della's sacrifices generous or just foolish? Why?
- Where did O. Henry plant clues about the twist ending? Did any of them tip you off while you were reading?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: O. Henry bio

WEEK 3 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 27

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

→ RECAP

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.13-19 "His savage barbarity" - "voice of tranquil music."

- Why do you think it is important for his narrative that Douglass describes violence in such detail? How does it strengthen his anti-slavery argument?
- Why was leaving Colonel Lloyd's plantation such a turning point for Douglass?

WEEK 3 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 27

"The Gold Bug" by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Edgar Allan Poe (1809–1849) is one of America's most distinctive and influential writers. Poe is known for dark, atmospheric tales of mystery and the macabre. Surprisingly, he also pioneered the detective story! Poe had a fascination with puzzles, codes, and the power of careful reasoning. Published in 1843, "The Gold Bug" is a mystery with a secret message written in code, and cracking it requires sharp eyes and sharp thinking. As you read, pay close attention when the cipher appears and to how the code is broken. If you'd like, see if you can work through it yourself!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.10-17 (stop at "we shall see!")

- How would you describe Legrand and Jupiter from what you've read so

★ TEACHER NOTE

"The Gold Bug" contains a repeated racial slur. Please preview for your students.

If you have already read this story, you may substitute "The Old Nurse's Story" by Elizabeth Gaskell. (Also included in the PDF for this course on p.38-50.)

Literature: Grades 7-8

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Term 3

far?

→ **VIEW (OPTIONAL)**

∞ Video Link: Edgar Allan Poe bio

WEEK 4 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 28

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

→ **RECAP**

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.19-26 "But alas!" - "learning how to write."

- How did Douglass's experiences with the Aulds set him "on the pathway from slavery to freedom"? Why did Mr. Auld forbid his wife to teach Douglass to read, and what did Douglass learn from this about literacy?
- How does Douglass teach himself to read and write? What obstacles does he face, and what does he learn about his own situation from what he reads?

WEEK 4 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 28

"The Gold Bug" by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ **RECAP**

What do you think will happen next during their adventure?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.17-23 "We crossed the creek" - "we had been digging."

- Does the narrator believe Legrand? What does he think has happened to Legrand? Do you agree?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 29

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

→ **RECAP**

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.26-33 "In a very short time" - "sagacity to see it."

- What was Douglass's and the other slaves' situation when his master, Captain Anthony, died? How does Douglass's direct description of valuation strengthen his argument against slavery?
- What is Douglass's life like once he lives with Thomas Auld?

WEEK 5 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 29

"The Gold Bug" by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ **RECAP**

What has happened so far during their adventure, especially while at the tree?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.23-29 "Around the new

Literature: Grades 7-8

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Term 3

position" - "place of deposit."

- The narrator immediately demands an explanation rather than simply celebrating when the treasure is found. Why do you think this is?
- We are told very little about who the narrator is. What do you know so far? Why do you think we are told so little?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 30

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

→ RECAP

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.33-39 "While I lived with my master" - "myself to my wretched lot."

- Why does Douglass call Edward Covey a "slave breaker"? What methods does Covey use to control enslaved people?
- How does Douglass describe the physical and emotional effects of his time with Covey?

WEEK 6 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 30

The Gold Bug by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ RECAP

What "links" of logic has Legrand revealed so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.30-37

- How much of finding the treasure was logic and how much was luck, in your opinion?

• COMPOSITION

"The Gold-Bug" is considered an early template for detective fiction. What elements fit that mold? What's missing that later detective stories (such as Sherlock Holmes) add?

WEEK 7 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 31

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

→ RECAP

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.39-45 "I have already intimated" - "practice is a very common one."

- Why do you think Douglass describes "this battle with Mr. Covey [as] the turning point in my career as a slave"?
- How does Douglass describe the celebration of Christmas for slaves as a tool of control rather than genuine kindness? How does this description support his anti-slavery argument?

WEEK 7 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 31

The Tale of the Golden Cockrel by Pushkin

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Alexander Pushkin (1799–1837) is Russia's most celebrated and beloved writer, widely considered the father of modern Russian literature. His poetry, novels, and stories established the literary tradition that nearly every Russian writer after him would build upon. Written in 1834, "The Tale of the Golden Cockerel" is one of his narrative poems written in the style



Term 3

of a Russian folktale. The story reads like a fairy tale but carries the sharp edge of a fable. As you read, ask yourself who holds the real power in this story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.51-56 "The Tale of the Golden Cockrel" by Pushkin

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- What kind of ruler is the king at the beginning of the story, and does your opinion of him change as the story progresses?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Web Link: Alexander Pushkin bio

WEEK 8 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 32

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

→ RECAP

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.45-52 "On the first of January" - "we succeeded very well."

- How does this section show the hypocrisy between the slave-holders' professions of Christianity and their actions?
- How does Douglass describe his time with Mr. Freeland?

WEEK 8 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 32

"How Much Land Does a Man Need?" by Leo Tolstoy

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Leo Tolstoy (1828–1910) is best known for his lengthy novels like War and Peace and Anna Karenina. But Tolstoy was also a master of the short story, and late in his life he turned increasingly toward simple, moral tales. Published in 1886, "How Much Land Does a Man Need?" is one of those tales. As you read, watch for how Tolstoy uses one man's desires to build suspense and make his argument.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.57-68 "How Much Land Does a Man Need?" by Leo Tolstoy

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- At the end of the story, the title's question is answered. Did the answer surprise you, or did you see it coming? Why?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 33

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

→ RECAP

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.52-58 "After a painful waiting" - "Christian city of Baltimore."

- What is Douglass's plan to escape to freedom? What happens?
- How does Douglass's experience working at the shipyard demonstrate the injustices of the law?



Term 3

WEEK 9 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 33

"The Kingdom of Cards" by Rabindranath Tagore

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Rabindranath Tagore (1861–1941) was a Bengali poet, writer, and philosopher from India who became the first non-European writer to win the Nobel Prize in Literature, receiving it in 1913. He was a prolific writer of poetry, short stories, novels, and plays, and is still considered one of the greatest literary figures of the modern era. His short story "The Kingdom of Cards" is written in the style of a fairy tale and uses an imaginary world to say something true about the real one.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.69-74 "The Kingdom of Cards" by Rabindranath Tagore

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Would you want to live in the Kingdom of Cards? What does your answer say about what you value?

WEEK 10 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 34

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

→ RECAP

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.58-63 "Master Hugh, finding he could" - "for the reasons before mentioned."

- Why doesn't Douglass provide more details about how he escaped?
- What does it mean for Douglass to "hire his time," and how does this practice reinforce the injustices of slavery?

WEEK 10 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 34

"The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Arthur Conan Doyle (1859–1930) was a British writer (born in Edinburgh, Scotland) and best known as the creator of Sherlock Holmes, arguably the most famous fictional detective in the world. He was knighted by King Edward VII in 1902. The Holmes stories defined the modern detective story and have never gone out of print. "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" is widely considered one of the finest Holmes stories ever written. As you read, pay attention to the clues Doyle plants along the way, and see how much you can figure out before he reveals the answer.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.75-85 "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Julia's mysterious dying words are "the speckled band!" Why do you think a dying clue is such a common device in detective fiction?
- Helen has been moved into her dead sister's room because of renovations, and this makes Holmes suspicious. Why do you think Helen herself didn't question it more?

• COMPOSITION

Holmes asks Watson to come along to Stoke Moran, warning him there will be danger. Why do you think Watson agrees to come? Is Watson, loyal, brave, or does he simply trust Holmes?

Literature: Grades 7-8

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Term 3

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: Arthur Conan Doyle bio

WEEK 11 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 35

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

→ RECAP

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.63-69 "I have been frequently asked" - "with my labors to decide."

- How does Douglass describe the feeling of finally being free?
- What circumstances prompt him to begin speaking and working as an abolitionist?

→ VIEW

Learn more about Frederick Douglass's later life.

∞ Video Link: Frederick Douglass: First African American Nominated for Vice President

• COMPOSITION

Outline Douglas's story and the circumstances that prompt him to begin speaking and working as an abolitionist.

WEEK 11 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 35

"The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.86-95 "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Holmes notices what others ignore. Is that a matter of intelligence, training, habit, or something else entirely?
- Arthur Conan Doyle considered this the best of all his Sherlock Holmes stories. (You can read his top 12 at the link below.) What do you think makes it so enduring? How does it compare to Poe's "The Gold-Bug" (written almost 50 years prior) as a piece of detective fiction?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Link: Arthur Conan Doyle's Favorite Sherlock Holmes Stories

WEEK 12 30m General Lit: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

WEEK 12 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

Literature: Grades 7-8

Examination

Term 1

Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8

- The Lightning Dreamer: Tula defies nearly every expectation placed on her. What does the novel suggest it truly costs to live an authentic life, and is that cost worth it?
- The Lightning Dreamer: Tula believes that poetry can change the world. By the end of the novel, do you think she has been proven right? Use moments from the story to support your position.

General Lit: Grades 7-8

- Little Women: Pilgrim's Progress is referred to multiple times in the book. Explain Jo's Apollyon in Ch.8, Meg's Vanity Fair in Ch.9, or discuss other parallels to Pilgrim's Progress that you've seen.

Sir Gibbie: If you have painted scenes from the story each week for your narrations, then write one of your favorite parts of the story so far. If you have told someone about the story each week for your narration, then paint or write about one of your favorite parts or scenes from the story so far.

Term 2

Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8

- A Christmas Carol: Explain how Scrooge changes from the beginning to the end of A Christmas Carol. What helps him change the most? Use examples from the story.

General Lit: Grades 7-8

- Act out OR write a scene from Little Women as a play.

Sir Gibbie: Paint or write about a favorite part of the story. Who were your favorite characters and why?

Term 3

Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8

- Short Stories and Folk Tales: Choose one story from this term that ends with a "twist" and explain how its ending works. What does it reveal? Why is it effective? What do you think the author most wanted you to take away?
- Short Stories and Folk Tales: Poe's Legrand and Doyle's Sherlock Holmes both solve mysteries through observation and logic, but they are very different kinds of characters. Compare and contrast the two. Which one did you find more compelling and why?

General Lit: Grades 7-8

- Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass: Explain why reading and literacy were such an important first step in Douglass's path from slavery to freedom. OR Describe some of the ways Douglass's Narrative is such a powerful argument against slavery.